插图英语阅读小册

第5册 · 十篇故事

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夺命毒雾：伦敦1952

The Killer Smog of 1952



温暖的炉火为何变成致命烟雾？

READ 纯净阅读 | CHECK 中文核对 | LEARN 词汇记忆 | RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

On Friday 5 December 1952, cold, stagnant air descended on London. Overhead, warmer air pressed down like a lid, holding the chill captive beneath. Londoners were accustomed to murky, dreary winters. This time, though, the capital's smoke was trapped too, thickening into a choking smog, a mix of smoke and fog.

That smoke, from coal burned in domestic fireplaces and power stations, was laden with soot and noxious sulphur dioxide. In places, visibility fell to a few metres. Ambulance services were suspended, an opera at the Sadler's Wells theatre was abandoned at the interval, and prize cattle at the Smithfield agricultural show died or had to be slaughtered.

The smog dissipated on Tuesday 9 December. Officials at the time put the excess deaths at about 4,000, but a 1954 Ministry of Health report blamed later deaths on influenza. A study published in Environmental Health Perspectives in 2001 reassessed the evidence and cast doubt on that explanation, estimating about 12,000 excess deaths between December 1952 and February 1953.

For decades Londoners had tolerated the smoke as a nuisance. One villain flickered in their own grates, a source of warmth and comfort so habitual that few thought to accuse it. Such complacency may help to explain the government's grudging response. It withstood pressure for an inquiry until May 1953.

Reform proved protracted, slowed by official inertia. The Clean Air Act became law on 5 July 1956, three and a half years after the smog. It empowered municipal councils to create smokeless zones, combating smoke at its source. The cosy hearth, beloved of British families, had, all along, been among the chief offenders.

中文译文

1952年12月5日星期五，寒冷而凝滞的空气笼罩了伦敦。上方较暖的空气像盖子一样压住下层，把冷空气困在下面。伦敦人早已习惯冬日的昏暗阴沉，但这一次，城里的煤烟也无法散去，越积越浓，与雾混合成令人窒息的烟雾。

煤烟来自家庭壁炉和发电厂燃烧的煤，其中含有大量烟尘和有毒的二氧化硫。有些地方的能见度降到只有几米。救护车服务暂停，萨德勒之井剧院的一场歌剧在幕间休息时中止，史密斯菲尔德农业展上的获奖牛也有的死亡，有的不得不被宰杀。

烟雾在12月9日星期二消散。当时官方估计，死亡人数比平常多出约4000人，但卫生部1954年的报告把后续死亡归咎于流感。2001年发表于《环境健康展望》的一项研究重新审查证据，对这种解释提出质疑，估计1952年12月至1953年2月期间的超额死亡约为1.2万人。

几十年来，伦敦人容忍着煤烟，只把它视为一种烦恼。其中一个元凶，就在自家的炉栅里闪烁：那是人们习以为常的温暖与舒适之源，很少有人想到要责怪它。这种安于现状的心态，或许能部分解释政府为什么不情愿作出回应。政府顶住要求调查的压力，一直拖到1953年5月。

改革旷日持久，又被官方的惰性拖慢。《清洁空气法》直到1956年7月5日才成为法律，距烟雾事件已过三年半。它授权市镇议会划设无烟区，从源头治理煤烟。英国家庭钟爱的温暖炉膛，原来始终都是主要的污染元凶之一。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

stagnant adj.
凝滞的；不流动的
5 December 1952, cold, stagnant air

descend on phr.v.
笼罩；降临于
stagnant air descended on London.

accustomed to adj.phr.
习惯于
accustomed to murky, dreary winters.

murky adj.
昏暗的；污浊的
accustomed to murky, dreary winters.

choking adj.
令人窒息的
thickening into a choking smog, a mix

smog n.
烟雾
thickening into a choking smog, a mix

laden with adj.phr.
充满；载有大量
was laden with soot and noxious

noxious adj.
有毒有害的
with soot and noxious sulphur dioxide.

visibility n.
能见度
In places, visibility fell to a few

suspend v.
暂停；中止
Ambulance services were suspended,

dissipate v.
消散
The smog dissipated on Tuesday 9

excess adj.
超出正常数量的
at the time put the excess deaths at

reassess v.
重新评估
reassessed the evidence

cast doubt on v.phr.
对……提出质疑
and cast doubt on that explanation,

nuisance n.
令人烦恼的事物
had tolerated the smoke as a nuisance.

habitual adj.
习惯性的；习以为常的
of warmth and comfort so habitual

complacency n.
自满；安于现状
Such complacency may help to explain

grudging adj.
不情愿的
the government's grudging response.

inquiry n.
调查
for an inquiry until May 1953.

protracted adj.
拖延很久的
Reform proved protracted, slowed by

inertia n.
惰性；因循不变
slowed by official inertia.

empower v.
授权
It empowered municipal councils to

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共34项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

overhead adv.
在头顶上方

lid n.
盖子

chill n.
寒气

captive adj.
被困住的

dreary adj.
阴沉乏味的

smoke n.
烟；煤烟

fog n.
雾

domestic adj.
家庭的

fireplace n.
壁炉

power station n.phr.
发电厂

ambulance n.
救护车

interval n.
幕间休息

cattle n.
牛；牛群

agricultural adj.
农业的

slaughter v.
宰杀

influenza n.
流感

explanation n.
解释

tolerate v.
容忍

villain n.
元凶；祸首

flicker v.
闪烁；摇曳

warmth n.
温暖

comfort n.
舒适

accuse v.
指责；归罪于

response n.
回应

withstand v.
顶住；抵挡

act n.
法案；法令

municipal adj.
市镇的

smokeless adj.
无烟的

combat v.
治理；对抗

source n.
源头；来源

cosy adj.
温暖舒适的

hearth n.
炉膛；壁炉前地面

beloved of adj.phr.
深受……喜爱的

offender n.
肇事者；此处指污染元凶

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 cold, _____ air descended on London.

02 was laden with soot and _____ sulphur dioxide.

03 reassessed the evidence and _____ that explanation,

04 Reform proved protracted, slowed by official _____.

文章主线

- 困住 1952年12月5至9日，伦敦上方暖空气像盖子压住冷空气，煤烟无法散去，形成致命烟雾。
- 源头 家庭壁炉和发电厂烧煤，释放烟尘及有毒二氧化硫；熟悉的温暖炉火也是污染元凶。
- 瘫痪 局部能见度仅几米，救护车停运、演出中止，农业展的牛也死亡或被迫宰杀。
- 复核 官方初估比常态多死亡约4000人，后续死亡曾被归于流感；2001年研究重估1952年12月至1953年2月，多死亡约1.2万人。
- 改革 政府拖延调查与改革，直到三年半后的1956年才制定《清洁空气法》，授权设无烟区，从源头控烟。

参考答案　1 stagnant 2 noxious 3 cast doubt on 4 inertia

稻济天下

Rice for the World



杂交稻的丰收，怎样由许多人共同促成？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In July 1964, inspecting rice ear by ear in a paddy at Anjiang Agricultural School in Hunan province, the instructor Yuan Longping spotted a peculiar plant. It was male-sterile, shedding no viable pollen. Rice pollinates itself, so breeding hybrid seed in bulk depends on such plants. In February 1966 he detailed the anomaly in the journal Chinese Science Bulletin.

The specimen launched a six-year hunt: Yuan and his colleagues could not breed a sterile line whose offspring reliably inherited the trait. The breakthrough came on 23 November 1970, in a marsh near Nanhong Farm in Sanya, Hainan. Yuan's assistant, Li Bihu, and Feng Keshan, a farm technician, found wild rice whose pollen was abortive.

Then came Yuan's decisive move: rather than withhold the strain, he distributed it to collaborators nationwide. Hybrids need three distinct lines: a sterile line, one to maintain its sterility, and one to restore fertility in the hybrids. Yan Longan's team in Jiangxi bred sterile lines and Zhang Xiancheng in Guangxi first identified a restorer line. In October 1973, at a national conference in Suzhou, Yuan declared the three-line system complete.

By 1976 hybrids were under cultivation on about 140,000 hectares. The World Food Prize Foundation estimates that hybrid rice can yield up to a fifth more grain than conventional varieties. By the early 2000s it covered almost half of China's rice fields.

Yuan, who shared the 2004 World Food Prize with Sierra Leone's Monty Jones, died in Changsha on 22 May 2021, aged 91. Yet popular myth portrays him as a solitary genius. His eye began the search; his generosity let many hands bring in the harvest.

中文译文

1964年7月，湖南安江农校教员袁隆平在稻田里逐穗检查，发现一株不同寻常的水稻：它雄性不育，无法散出有活性的花粉。水稻通常自花授粉，因此大批量培育杂交种子，需要这样的植株。1966年2月，他在《科学通报》详细报告了这一反常现象。

这株标本开启了长达六年的搜寻。袁隆平与同事一直无法育成一个不育系，使其后代稳定继承雄性不育的性状。突破出现在1970年11月23日：在海南三亚南红农场附近的沼泽中，袁隆平的助手李必湖和农场技术员冯克珊找到了花粉败育的野生稻。

袁隆平随后作出了关键决定：他没有将这个品系留在自己手中，而是把材料分给全国各地的协作者。杂交稻需要三个不同的系：不育系、保持其不育性的保持系，以及让杂交后代恢复育性的恢复系。江西颜龙安团队育成了不育系，广西张先程率先找到了恢复系。1973年10月，袁隆平在苏州的一次全国会议上宣布，三系已经配套。

到1976年，杂交稻种植面积约为14万公顷。世界粮食奖基金会估计，它比常规品种最多可多产五分之一的稻谷。到21世纪初，杂交稻已覆盖中国近一半稻田。

袁隆平与塞拉利昂的蒙蒂·琼斯共同获得2004年世界粮食奖。他于2021年5月22日在长沙去世，享年91岁。然而，流行的传奇常把他描绘成单枪匹马的天才。他的敏锐观察开启了搜寻，他愿意分享材料，才让许多人的共同努力促成丰收。

雄性不育指缺少有效花粉；植株仍能作母本接受其他植株的花粉。文中的增产两成是基金会估计的最高幅度。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

inspect v.
仔细检查
inspecting rice ear by ear

peculiar adj.
不同寻常的
a peculiar plant

sterile adj.
不育的；本文指雄性不育
It was male-sterile

viable adj.
有活性的；能正常发育的
no viable pollen

pollen n.
花粉
no viable pollen

hybrid adj.
杂交的
breeding hybrid seed in bulk

in bulk 介词短语
大批量地
breeding hybrid seed in bulk

anomaly n.
反常现象
detailed the anomaly

specimen n.
标本
The specimen launched a six-year hunt

breed v.
培育；繁育
breed a sterile line

inherit v.
遗传获得
reliably inherited the trait

trait n.
性状；特征
reliably inherited the trait

breakthrough n.
突破
The breakthrough came

abortive adj.
（花粉）败育的
whose pollen was abortive

decisive adj.
关键的；决定性的
Yuan's decisive move

withhold v.
不予提供；保留
rather than withhold the strain

collaborator n.
协作者
collaborators nationwide

distinct adj.
不同的
three distinct lines

restore v.
恢复
restore fertility in the hybrids

fertility n.
育性；繁殖能力
restore fertility in the hybrids

yield v.
产出
yield up to a fifth more grain

generosity n.
慷慨；乐于分享
his generosity

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共37项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

paddy n.
稻田

instructor n.
教员

shed v.
散出；释放

pollinate itself 动词短语
自花授粉

detail v.
详细描述

journal n.
学术期刊

launch v.
开启；发起

hunt n.
搜寻

colleague n.
同事

offspring n.
后代

reliably adv.
稳定可靠地

marsh n.
沼泽

technician n.
技术员

strain n.
品系

distribute v.
分发

to prep.
给；向

nationwide adv.
在全国范围

maintain v.
保持

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共37项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

sterility n.
不育性

identify v.
找出；确认

national conference n.
全国性会议

declare v.
宣布

under cultivation 介词短语
处于种植中

hectare n.
公顷

estimate v.
估计

grain n.
谷物；此处指稻谷

conventional adj.
常规的

variety n.
品种

cover v.
覆盖；占据

rice field n.
稻田

World Food Prize n.
世界粮食奖

myth n.
流传的错误观念

portray v.
描绘

as prep.
作为；描绘成

solitary adj.
独自一人的

genius n.
天才

bring in the harvest 动词短语
收获庄稼；促成丰收

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 In July 1964, inspecting rice ear by ear in a paddy at Anjiang Agricultural School in Hunan province, the instructor Yuan Longping spotted a _____ plant.

02 It was male-sterile, shedding no _____ pollen.

03 Then came Yuan's decisive move: rather than _____ the strain, he distributed it to collaborators nationwide.

04 The World Food Prize Foundation estimates that hybrid rice can _____ up to a fifth more grain than conventional varieties.

文章主线

- 难题 水稻通常自花授粉，大批杂交制种要用不产有效花粉的母株；袁隆平1964年发现这样的稻株，却难让后代稳定保持不育性。
- 协作 1970年李必湖、冯克珊找到花粉败育野生稻；袁隆平向全国团队共享材料，颜龙安团队育成不育系，张先程率先找到恢复系。
- 机制 1973年三系配套：不育系作母本；保持系为母本授粉，繁殖仍不育的母株；恢复系为母本授粉，产生可结实的杂交后代。
- 推广 1976年已种约14万公顷，21世纪初覆盖中国近半稻田；世界粮食奖基金会估计，最多比常规稻增产两成。
- 贡献 袁隆平的发现、材料共享与全国协作共同促成丰收，并非一人独创；他2004年共获世界粮食奖，2021年去世。

参考答案　1 peculiar 2 viable 3 withhold 4 yield

炸药大王的救心药

Dynamite for the Heart



同一种液体，怎样既能炸山又能救心？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

Around 1847 the Italian chemist Sobrero first made nitroglycerin, a colourless, oily liquid of acute instability. A mere droplet on the tongue, he reported, left his head throbbing violently for hours. On 3 September 1864 a nitroglycerin shed in Stockholm exploded. The tragic blast killed five, including Alfred Nobel's younger brother Emil.

Nobel tamed the liquid by blending it with kieselguhr, a porous earth, into a paste shaped into rods. Patented in 1867 as dynamite, it was harnessed for mining, quarrying, and demolition, enriching him immensely. His 1895 testament made the fortune an endowment for prizes, first awarded in 1901.

Nitroglycerin had side-effects. Factory operatives suffered racking headaches, and their tolerance, built over the week, ebbed at weekends. Mondays brought a recurrence, with dizziness and palpitations, hence the name Monday disease. In 1879 William Murrell reported in The Lancet on its therapeutic use against angina pectoris, attacks of chest pain.

On 25 October 1896 Nobel, who had angina, wrote to his aide that by an irony of fate doctors had prescribed him nitroglycerin to take internally. Its alias, Trinitrin, was chosen, he explained, to avoid frightening pharmacists or the public. He did not comply. Partly paralysed by a cerebral haemorrhage, he died at his San Remo villa on 10 December 1896.

In 1977 Murad ascertained that nitroglycerin releases nitric oxide, which widens blood vessels. Furchgott found an unidentified relaxing factor in vascular linings in 1980, and Ignarro recognised it as nitric oxide in 1986. The trio shared the 1998 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine. Its presentation speech, on 10 December, the anniversary of Nobel's death, quoted his ironic letter.

中文译文

1847年前后，意大利化学家索布雷罗首次制得硝酸甘油。这是一种无色、油状、极不稳定的液体。他报告说，仅在舌头上滴一小滴，就会使头部剧烈抽痛数小时。1864年9月3日，斯德哥尔摩一间存放硝酸甘油的棚屋爆炸，造成五人死亡，其中包括阿尔弗雷德·诺贝尔的弟弟埃米尔。

诺贝尔将这种液体与多孔的硅藻土混合，制成糊状物，再塑成棒状，使它变得更可控。这种炸药于1867年获得专利，用于采矿、采石和拆除工程，让他积累了巨额财富。他在1895年立下遗嘱，以这笔财产设立奖项基金，奖项于1901年首次颁发。

硝酸甘油也有副作用。工厂工人饱受剧烈头痛之苦；他们在一周工作中逐渐产生的耐受性，到周末又会减退。每到星期一，头痛便再次发作，还伴有眩晕和心悸，因此被称为“星期一病”。1879年，威廉·默雷尔在《柳叶刀》报告了硝酸甘油治疗心绞痛的用途。心绞痛就是阵发性的胸痛。

1896年10月25日，患有心绞痛的诺贝尔写信给助手，感叹命运的讽刺：医生竟开了硝酸甘油让他内服。他解释说，这种药另取名为Trinitrin，是为了不吓到药剂师或公众。他没有遵从医嘱。后来，他因脑出血而部分瘫痪，于1896年12月10日在圣雷莫的别墅中去世。

1977年，穆拉德查明，硝酸甘油会释放一氧化氮，使血管扩张。1980年，弗奇戈特在血管内壁发现了一种身份尚不明确的舒张因子；1986年，伊格纳罗认定它就是一氧化氮。三人共同获得1998年诺贝尔生理学或医学奖。12月10日颁奖时，致辞引用了诺贝尔那封感叹命运讽刺的信；那天也正是他的逝世纪念日。

未遵医嘱与死亡不应混作因果；文章明确交代诺贝尔脑出血。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

chemist n.
化学家
the Italian chemist Sobrero

nitroglycerin n.
硝酸甘油
first made nitroglycerin

acute adj.
极度的；严重的
of acute instability

instability n.
不稳定性
of acute instability

tame v.
使受控；驯服
Nobel tamed the liquid

blend v.
混合
blending it with kieselguhr

porous adj.
多孔的
a porous earth

harness v.
控制并利用
harnessed for mining

demolition n.
拆除工程
mining, quarrying, and demolition

enrich v.
使富有
enriching him immensely

testament n.
遗嘱
His 1895 testament

fortune n.
巨额财富
the fortune an endowment

endowment n.
捐赠基金
an endowment for prizes

tolerance n.
耐受性
their tolerance

recurrence n.
复发
a recurrence, with dizziness

therapeutic adj.
治疗的；有疗效的
its therapeutic use

prescribe v.
开具（药物）处方
doctors had prescribed him

comply v.
遵从
He did not comply

ascertain v.
查明
Murad ascertained

unidentified adj.
尚未确认身份的
an unidentified relaxing factor

vascular adj.
血管的
vascular linings

anniversary n.
周年纪念日
the anniversary of Nobel's death

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

Italian adj.
意大利的

colourless adj.
无色的

oily adj.
油状的

liquid n.
液体

mere adj.
仅仅的；不过是

droplet n.
小滴

throb v.
一阵阵抽痛

violently adv.
剧烈地

shed n.
棚屋

tragic adj.
悲惨的

paste n.
糊状物

rod n.
棒；条

mining n.
采矿

quarrying n.
采石

immensely adv.
极其

nitroglycerin n.
硝酸甘油

side effect n.
副作用

factory operative n.
工厂工人

racking adj.
剧烈折磨人的

ebb v.
减退

dizziness n.
眩晕

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

palpitation n.
心悸

hence adv.
因此

aide n.
助手

by an irony of fate 介词短语
命运弄人地

internally adv.
通过内服

alias n.
别名

frighten v.
使害怕

pharmacist n.
药剂师

partly adv.
部分地

paralyse v.
使瘫痪

cerebral haemorrhage n.
脑出血

villa n.
别墅

nitric oxide n.
一氧化氮

widen v.
使扩张

factor n.
因子

lining n.
内壁；内层

trio n.
三人组

Nobel Prize n.
诺贝尔奖

presentation n.
颁授；颁奖

quote v.
引用

ironic adj.
具有讽刺意味的

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Around 1847 the Italian chemist Sobrero first made nitroglycerin, a colourless, oily liquid of acute _____.

02 Factory operatives suffered racking headaches, and their _____, built over the week, ebbed at weekends.

03 He did not _____.

04 In 1977 Murad _____ that nitroglycerin releases nitric oxide, which widens blood vessels.

文章主线

- 危险 1847年前后，索布雷罗制得极不稳定的硝酸甘油；1864年的爆炸夺走五人生命，包括诺贝尔的弟弟。
- 炸药 诺贝尔将硝酸甘油与硅藻土混合制成炸药，1867年获专利，凭此致富，后来遗赠财产设立奖项。
- 药用 工人接触它会头痛，周末耐受下降、周一复发；1879年，默雷尔报告它能治疗心绞痛。
- 讽刺 诺贝尔晚年患心绞痛，也被开了硝酸甘油；他写信感叹命运讽刺，却未遵医嘱。他于1896年死于脑出血。
- 揭谜 后来查明它释放一氧化氮、扩张血管；三位相关研究者获1998年生理学或医学诺奖，颁奖致辞在诺贝尔忌日引用了这封信。

参考答案　1 instability 2 tolerance 3 comply 4 ascertained

被拒绝了十二次的哈利·波特

The Book Twelve Publishers Turned Down



十二次拒绝后，一位八岁读者带来了什么转机？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In 1990, on a delayed train from Manchester to London's King's Cross, Joanne Rowling, a would-be novelist, was unexpectedly struck by the inspiration for Harry Potter, an orphaned young wizard. Grief soon overshadowed that spark: her mother died on 30 December 1990, aged 45. Rowling then relocated to Porto to teach English.

Rowling married in Porto in October 1992, and a daughter's arrival in July 1993 ushered in motherhood. At the end of 1993 she resettled in Edinburgh, a lone mother reliant on state welfare. She habitually wrote in cafés, patiently polishing her unfinished novel.

A literary agent, Christopher Little, took on the manuscript and pitched it repeatedly to prospective buyers. It was reportedly rejected by twelve publishers in succession, a relentless run of refusals that offered the newcomer little encouragement.

At Bloomsbury, the chairman Nigel Newton gave the first chapter to his eight-year-old daughter, Alice, who relished it and eagerly asked for the next instalment. The firm paid a sum of 1,500 pounds as an advance. Fearful that boys might disregard a book by a woman, the publishers opted for initials to mask her gender. Having no middle name, Rowling took the K for her pseudonym from her grandmother Kathleen.

Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone was published on 26 June 1997, in a cautious first print run of 500 hardbacks, 300 allocated to libraries. The American publisher Scholastic paid $105,000 for the US rights, and the renamed Sorcerer's Stone appeared there on 1 September 1998. The series and its spin-off volumes have collectively surpassed 500 million copies sold, in 80 languages. Alice's appetite was evidently shared by millions.

中文译文

1990年，一列从曼彻斯特驶往伦敦国王十字车站的火车晚点了。车上，想成为小说家的乔安妮·罗琳意外得到灵感，构思出孤儿少年巫师哈利·波特。然而悲痛很快掩盖了这点火花：母亲于1990年12月30日去世，年仅45岁。罗琳随后移居波尔图，教授英语。

罗琳于1992年10月在波尔图结婚，1993年7月女儿降生，她开始为人母。同年年底，她在爱丁堡重新安家，成为依靠国家福利生活的单亲母亲。她常在咖啡馆写作，耐心打磨那部尚未完成的小说。

文学经纪人克里斯托弗·利特尔接下书稿，多次向潜在买家推介。据报道，书稿接连被十二家出版社拒绝。这一连串毫不留情的回绝，几乎没有给这位新人带来鼓励。

布卢姆斯伯里出版社董事长奈杰尔·牛顿把第一章给八岁的女儿爱丽丝看。她读得津津有味，急着要下一部分。出版社支付了1500英镑预付金。担心男孩会忽略女作者的书，出版方选择用名字首字母缩写掩去作者性别。罗琳没有中间名，便从祖母凯瑟琳的名字中取来K，组成笔名的一部分。

《哈利·波特与魔法石》于1997年6月26日出版，第一批精装本谨慎地只印了500册，其中300册分配给图书馆。美国学乐出版社花10.5万美元买下美国版权；更换英文书名后的美版于1998年9月1日问世。这一系列及衍生图书后来已有80种语言版本，合计销量超过五亿册。显然，数百万读者和爱丽丝有着同样的阅读胃口。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

inspiration n.
灵感
the inspiration for Harry Potter

grief n.
悲痛
Grief soon overshadowed that spark

overshadow v.
使黯然失色；盖过
overshadowed that spark

relocate v.
移居
relocated to Porto

usher in 动词短语
开启；带来
ushered in motherhood

reliant on 形容词短语
依靠
reliant on state welfare

welfare n.
政府福利救济
state welfare

polish v.
润色；打磨
polishing her unfinished novel

literary adj.
文学的
A literary agent

pitch v.
推介；推销
pitched it repeatedly

prospective adj.
潜在的；可能成为的
prospective buyers

reject v.
拒绝
rejected by twelve publishers

in succession 介词短语
接连；连续
twelve publishers in succession

relish v.
十分享受；津津有味地读
who relished it

disregard v.
忽视
disregard a book by a woman

opt for 动词短语
选择
opted for initials

initial n.
姓名首字母缩写
initials to mask her gender

pseudonym n.
笔名
the K for her pseudonym

hardback n.
精装本
first print run of 500 hardbacks

allocate v.
分配
300 allocated to libraries

collectively adv.
合计；共同地
have collectively surpassed

surpass v.
超过
surpassed 500 million copies sold

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共38项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

delay v.（分词作定语）
延误；晚点

Manchester 专名
曼彻斯特

would-be adj.
有志成为的

novelist n.
小说家

unexpectedly adv.
出乎意料地

orphaned adj.
失去父母的；成为孤儿的

wizard n.
巫师

spark n.
火花；灵感的萌芽

arrival n.
降生；到来

motherhood n.
为人母的生活

resettle v.
重新安家

Edinburgh 专名
爱丁堡

lone adj.
独自的；单亲的

habitually adv.
习惯性地；经常

patiently adv.
耐心地

unfinished adj.
尚未完成的

take on 动词短语
接手；接下

repeatedly adv.
多次地

relentless adj.
毫不留情的；持续不断的

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共38项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

refusal n.
回绝

newcomer n.
新人

encouragement n.
鼓励

chairman n.
董事长

chapter n.
章

eagerly adv.
急切地

instalment n.
分期的一部分；此指后续章节

a sum of 名词短语
一笔……的款项

as an advance 介词短语
作为预付金

fearful adj.
担心的

mask v.
掩饰；隐瞒

gender n.
性别

cautious adj.
谨慎的

rename v.
更名

series n.
系列

spin-off adj.
衍生的

volume n.
书；卷

appetite n.
阅读欲望；兴趣

evidently adv.
显然

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 It was reportedly _____ by twelve publishers in succession

02 the publishers _____ initials to mask her gender.

03 in a cautious first print run of 500 _____

04 The series and its spin-off volumes have collectively _____ 500 million copies sold, in 80 languages.

文章主线

- 起笔 1990年，罗琳在一列晚点火车上得到哈利·波特的灵感，开始构思孤儿巫师的故事。
- 坚持 经历丧母后，她在爱丁堡独自抚养女儿，依靠福利生活，仍常在咖啡馆打磨小说。
- 转机 书稿据报遭十二家出版社拒绝；布卢姆斯伯里董事长的八岁女儿爱丽丝，读首章后急着看后续。
- 问世 该社接纳书稿，因担心男孩忽略女作者的书，采用J.K.缩写署名；1997年首册《魔法石》在英国首印500册精装本。
- 回响 美国版于1998年问世；系列及衍生图书后来已有80种语言版本，合计销量超过五亿册。

参考答案　1 rejected 2 opted for 3 hardbacks 4 surpassed

从空气中造面包

The Bread Made from Air



同一种化学工艺，为何既能养人也能助战?

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In July 1909, BASF envoys gathered round a squat machine on a bench in Fritz Haber's Karlsruhe laboratory. Behind its gleaming, bolted valves, nitrogen and hydrogen met at crushing pressure and furnace heat, and transparent beads of ammonia began to drip slowly. Haber had pried nourishment from the air.

BASF's Carl Bosch scaled the method up, and from 1913 a gigantic plant at Oppau mass-produced ammonia. Hailed for making bread from air, Haber won the coveted 1918 Nobel Prize. Ploughed into stony soils as fertiliser, ammonia wards off famine as no manure heap could, bringing abundance. By 2008 it was feeding nearly half of mankind.

Haber's ambition had a sinister side. Ammonia stocked Germany's arsenal with nitrates for munitions despite a British blockade, and Captain Haber marshalled chemical warfare. On 22 April 1915 at Ypres, troops vented about 168 tonnes of greenish, poisonous chlorine towards the Allied trenches, the first large-scale gas onslaught.

Haber's wife, Clara Immerwahr, Germany's first woman with a doctoral degree in chemistry, voiced objections to his work. On 2 May 1915, after festivities in his honour, she shot herself in the garden with his service pistol. The next day the widower left for the Eastern Front.

Prestige offered no sanctuary. Of Jewish origin, Haber left Germany an outcast after Hitler's regime seized power, dying in Basel in 1934. His institute's pesticide research had produced Zyklon. A later variant, Zyklon B, was used in Nazi death camps, where relatives of his died.

About half the nitrogen in our proteins and DNA has passed through a Haber-Bosch factory, so each of us carries a little of Haber's chemistry.

中文译文

1909年7月，BASF公司的代表围在弗里茨·哈伯位于卡尔斯鲁厄的实验室工作台旁，看着一台矮壮的机器。在闪亮、用螺栓紧固的阀门后，氮与氢在极高压力和熔炉般的高温下反应，透明的氨液滴开始缓缓滴落。哈伯从空气中撬出了养分。

BASF的卡尔·博施将这一方法扩大到工业规模。1913年起，奥保的一座大型工厂开始批量生产氨。哈伯因“从空气中造面包”而广受赞誉，获得了令人向往的1918年诺贝尔奖。氨作为化肥被施入多石的土壤，以粪肥远不能及的能力抵御饥荒，带来丰收。到2008年，它已养活近半数人类。

哈伯的雄心也有阴暗的一面。尽管英国实施封锁，氨仍为德国军火库提供制造弹药所需的硝酸盐；而哈伯上尉则组织化学战。1915年4月22日，在伊普尔，德军向协约国战壕排放了约168吨黄绿色的有毒氯气，发动了首次大规模毒气攻击。

哈伯的妻子克拉拉·伊梅瓦尔是德国首位获得化学博士学位的女性，她曾反对他的工作。1915年5月2日，在为哈伯举行的庆祝活动之后，她在花园中用他的军用手枪自杀。次日，这位刚刚丧妻的人便前往东线。

声望并未给哈伯提供庇护。身为犹太裔，他在希特勒政权掌权后受到排斥，离开德国，1934年死于巴塞尔。他所在研究所的杀虫剂研究曾催生齐克隆；后来的变体齐克隆B被用于纳粹死亡营，他的一些亲属也死在这些营中。

我们体内蛋白质和DNA所含的氮，约有一半曾经过哈伯—博施工厂。因此，每个人的身体里都带着一点哈伯化学的痕迹。

齐克隆B是后来的变体；文中未认定哈伯亲属的具体死因。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

valve n.
阀门
its gleaming, bolted valves

ammonia n.
氨
transparent beads of ammonia

nourishment n.
养分；营养
pried nourishment from the air

scale up 动词短语
扩大规模
scaled the method up

mass-produce v.
批量生产
mass-produced ammonia

coveted adj.
人人渴望得到的
the coveted 1918 Nobel Prize

fertiliser n.
化肥；肥料
as fertiliser

ward off 动词短语
抵御；防止
ammonia wards off famine

famine n.
饥荒
ammonia wards off famine

abundance n.
丰饶；充裕
bringing abundance

sinister adj.
险恶的；阴暗的
a sinister side

arsenal n.
军火库
Germany's arsenal

munitions n.
弹药；军需品
nitrates for munitions

blockade n.
封锁
despite a British blockade

marshal v.
统筹；组织调度
marshalled chemical warfare

onslaught n.
猛烈攻击
the first large-scale gas onslaught

objection to 名词短语
对……的反对意见
voiced objections to his work

sanctuary n.
庇护；避难所
Prestige offered no sanctuary

outcast n.
被排斥的人
left Germany an outcast

pesticide n.
杀虫剂；农药
His institute's pesticide research

variant n.
变体
A later variant, Zyklon B

nitrogen n.
氮
nitrogen and hydrogen met

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共38项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

envoy n.
代表；使者

squat adj.
矮壮的；矮而宽的

bench n.
实验工作台

gleaming adj.
闪亮的

bolted adj.
用螺栓紧固的

crushing adj.
极高的；压倒性的

furnace n.
熔炉；高温炉

transparent adj.
透明的

bead n.
液体小滴

drip v.
滴落

slowly adv.
缓慢地

pry v.
撬出；费力取得

from prep.
从；由

up adv.
表示规模扩大

gigantic adj.
巨大的

hail for 动词短语
因……而受到赞誉

plough into 动词短语
翻耕埋入；施入土壤

stony adj.
多石的

soil n.
土壤

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共38项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

manure n.
粪肥

heap n.
堆；一堆

mankind n.
人类

ambition n.
雄心；抱负

stock v.
为……储备；充实

with prep.
用；以（stock…with搭配）

vent v.
排放；释放气体

greenish adj.
略带绿色的

poisonous adj.
有毒的

trench n.
战壕

doctoral adj.
博士学位的

festivity n.
庆祝活动

pistol n.
手枪

widower n.
鳏夫；丧妻的人

prestige n.
声望；威望

regime n.
政权

seize v.
夺取；攫取

protein n.
蛋白质

pass through 动词短语
经过；通过

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Behind its gleaming, bolted valves, nitrogen and hydrogen met at crushing pressure and furnace heat, and transparent beads of _____ began to drip slowly.

02 Ploughed into stony soils as _____, ammonia wards off famine as no manure heap could, bringing abundance.

03 Haber's ambition had a _____ side.

04 Prestige offered no _____.

文章主线

- 突破 1909年哈伯用空气里的氮，在高温高压下与氢合成氨；博施将其放大，1913年实现工业量产。
- 养育 氨制成化肥，提高粮食产量，到2008年已支撑近半人类；人体蛋白质和DNA中约一半的氮也经此工艺。
- 战争 合成氨也供应弹药原料；哈伯1915年组织首次大规模毒气攻击，妻子反对其战争工作。
- 命运 妻子后来自杀，他次日仍赴前线；虽获1918年诺奖，犹太裔的他后来仍遭纳粹排斥，1934年死于流亡中。
- 余波 他研究所的杀虫剂齐克隆，后来衍生出齐克隆B；纳粹将其用于死亡营，他的一些亲属也死在营中。

参考答案　1 ammonia 2 fertiliser 3 sinister 4 sanctuary

失败的胶水，成功的便利贴

The Glue That Failed Its Way to Success



黏得不牢的胶，为什么成了畅销文具？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In 1968 Spencer Silver, a scientist at 3M, set out to make a super-strong adhesive. The polymer he produced did something else. Its tiny spheres formed a layer with little tack, giving paper a temporary hold, so it would adhere, peel off, and be reapplied. To an inventor chasing strength, the formulation was a setback.

For five years Silver acted as its promoter within 3M's corporate ranks, in informal chats and at seminars. In his own summary, it was a solution without a problem. His perseverance met indifference. The unconventional material found no use, and the pursuit proved fruitless.

In 1974 Art Fry, a colleague who had heard one of those talks, faced a small annoyance at church. The paper bookmarks wedged in his choir's hymn book kept getting dislodged and falling out. The frustration gave Fry an idea. The unwanted adhesive could make a marker that would cling to a page, stay put, and leave it undamaged.

In 1977 the notes were test-marketed as Press 'n Peel in four American cities, where purchasers showed little enthusiasm. In 1978 3M's marketers staged a blitz in Boise, Idaho, and dispensed complimentary packets of notes to offices. More than 90 per cent of respondents who tried them said they would buy. After the coolness came a turnaround.

On 6 April 1980 the pads, rebranded as Post-it Notes, went on sale nationally in the US, and Canada and Europe followed in 1981. The stationery staple owes its signature canary tone to an unplanned twist. The laboratory next door had only leftover yellow paper.

中文译文

1968年，3M公司的科学家斯潘塞·西尔弗着手研制超强黏合剂，做出的聚合物却有另一种性能：微小球粒形成黏性较弱的涂层，让纸张暂时贴住，揭下后还能重新贴上。对追求黏合强度的发明者来说，这个配方却是一次挫折。

此后五年，西尔弗在3M内部不断推广它，在闲聊和研讨会上反复介绍。用他自己的话说，这是一个还没找到问题的解决方案。他的坚持换来的却是冷淡。这种不同寻常的材料始终找不到用途，探索似乎毫无结果。

1974年，听过他一次讲座的同事阿特·弗莱在教堂遇到一件烦心事：夹在唱诗班赞美诗集里的纸书签总是移位、掉落。这种挫败感让他想到，没人要的弱黏胶，也许能做出贴在书页上、不易移动、揭下又不伤纸的书签。

1977年，这种便条以Press’n Peel之名在美国四个城市试销，购买者反应冷淡。1978年，3M的营销人员在爱达荷州博伊西发动密集推广，向办公室免费派发一包包便条。试用过的受访者中，超过90%表示愿意购买。产品终于由冷遇迎来转机。

1980年4月6日，产品以“便利贴”的新名字在美国全国销售，1981年又进入加拿大和欧洲。如今这种文具已是常用品；它标志性的金丝雀黄色却纯属偶然：当时隔壁实验室只有剩下的黄纸。

超过90%说愿意购买，指试用后的受访者，不是所有消费者，也不是实际购买率。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

adhesive n.
黏合剂
a super-strong adhesive

polymer n.
聚合物
The polymer he produced

tack n.
黏着力
with little tack

temporary adj.
暂时的
a temporary hold

adhere v.
黏附
adhere, peel off, and be reapplied

peel off 动词短语
揭下；剥离
adhere, peel off, and be reapplied

formulation n.
配方
the formulation was a setback

setback n.
挫折
the formulation was a setback

perseverance n.
坚持不懈
His perseverance met indifference

indifference n.
冷淡；漠不关心
His perseverance met indifference

unconventional adj.
不同寻常的
The unconventional material

fruitless adj.
无结果的
the pursuit proved fruitless

dislodge v.
使移位
getting dislodged and falling out

frustration n.
挫败；懊恼
The frustration gave Fry an idea

cling to 动词短语
黏在；紧附
cling to a page

test-market v.
试销
the notes were test-marketed

enthusiasm n.
热情
purchasers showed little enthusiasm

dispense v.
分发
dispensed complimentary packets

complimentary adj.
免费赠送的
complimentary packets of notes

respondent n.
受访者
respondents who tried them

turnaround n.
转机；好转
After the coolness came a turnaround

staple n.
常用品
The stationery staple

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共41项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

set out to 动词短语
着手；开始做

super-strong adj.
超强的

something else 代词短语
别的东西；另一回事

sphere n.
球状颗粒

reapply v.
重新贴上

inventor n.
发明者

act as 动词短语
充当

promoter n.
推广者

corporate adj.
公司的

informal adj.
非正式的

seminar n.
研讨会

summary n.
概括；总结

solution n.
解决方案

find no use 动词短语
找不到用途

pursuit n.
探索；追求

annoyance n.
烦心事

bookmark n.
书签

wedge v.
夹住；塞入

choir n.
唱诗班

hymn n.
赞美诗

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共41项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

fall out 动词短语
掉出来

unwanted adj.
没人要的

stay put 动词短语
留在原处

undamaged adj.
完好无损的

note n.
便条

purchaser n.
购买者

marketer n.
营销人员

stage v.
组织；发起

blitz n.
密集攻势

packet n.
小包

coolness n.
冷淡

pad n.
便笺本

rebrand as 动词短语
更名为；改品牌为

Post-it Notes n.
便利贴（产品名）

nationally adv.
在全国

stationery n.
文具

signature adj.
标志性的

canary adj.
金丝雀黄色的

tone n.
色调

unplanned adj.
计划外的

leftover adj.
剩余的

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 In 1968 Spencer Silver, a scientist at 3M, set out to make a super-strong _____.

02 His _____ met indifference.

03 In 1978 3M's marketers staged a blitz in Boise, Idaho, and dispensed _____ packets of notes to offices.

04 After the coolness came a _____.

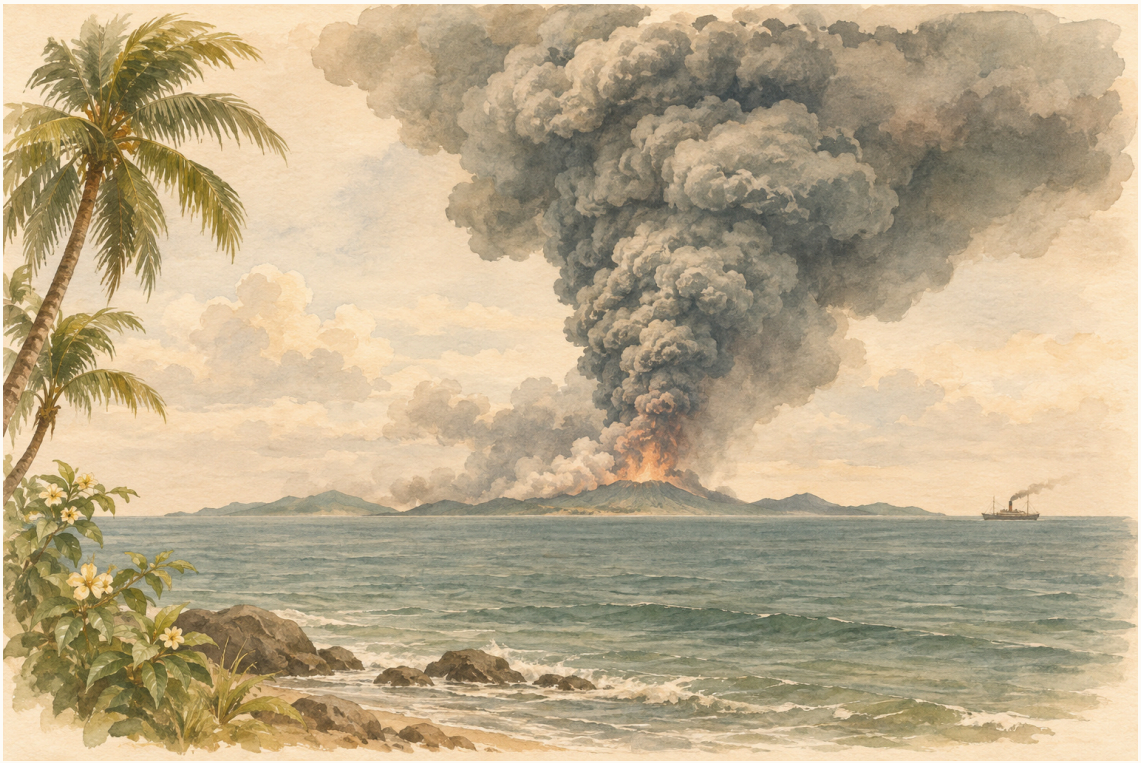
文章主线

- 意外 1968年，3M的西尔弗想造超强胶，却做出由微小球粒组成的弱黏胶，纸张能贴住、揭下再贴。
- 用途 他在公司推广多年后，同事弗莱于1974年想到，用这种胶固定总从赞美诗集中滑落的书签，且不伤书页。
- 冷遇 1977年，这种便条在美国四个城市试销，消费者反应冷淡。
- 转机 1978年，3M在博伊西向办公室免费发试用品；试用过的受访者中，超过九成表示愿意购买。
- 上市 1980年，产品改名“便利贴”在全美上市，次年进入加拿大和欧洲；标志性的黄色，仅因隔壁实验室剩下黄纸。

参考答案　1 adhesive 2 perseverance 3 complimentary 4 turnaround

震动世界的一声巨响

The Sound That Shook the World



火山的一声巨响，如何传遍世界？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

Shortly after ten in the morning on 27 August 1883, Krakatoa, a volcanic island in the Sunda Strait, unleashed its most thunderous explosion. About four hours later, islanders on Rodrigues, nearly 4,800 kilometres across the Indian Ocean, took the roar for distant gunfire. Barometers worldwide recorded the atmospheric pressure wave, some of them seven times in about five days.

Restless since 20 May, the volcano reached a catastrophic climax on 26–27 August. About two-thirds of the island collapsed into its emptied magma chamber, vanishing beneath the sea. Tsunamis, reportedly over 30 metres high in places, swamped coastal settlements on Java and Sumatra. Dutch colonial administrators counted 36,417 dead, mostly drowned, perhaps underestimating the toll.

Telegrams from Batavia (now Jakarta), relayed by submarine cable, reached London within hours. Western newspapers soon began chronicling what is often called the first global news event. Yet early dispatches were terse; the magnitude of the devastation emerged piecemeal over days.

Ash and sulphur dioxide, hurled tens of kilometres high, formed a haze that circled the equator in about two weeks. In November 1883, crimson sunsets glowed over Europe and North America, summoning firefighters in New York and Connecticut to phantom blazes. Later climate reconstructions suggest global temperatures dipped a few tenths of a degree the following year.

Some experts discounted the volcanic explanation, blaming the sunsets on moisture at high altitude or cosmic dust. In February 1884, Britain's Royal Society appealed in The Times for dated observations, eliciting worldwide replies; the Society's 1888 report tied the glow to Krakatoa. Through barometers, cables, and crimson skies, far-flung observers began to glimpse how interconnected the planet already was.

中文译文

1883年8月27日上午10点刚过，巽他海峡的火山岛喀拉喀托发生了最震耳欲聋的一次爆炸。约四小时后，远隔印度洋、距其近4800公里的罗德里格斯岛居民，把轰鸣误当成远处的炮声。世界各地的气压计都记录到了大气压力波，一些仪器在大约五天内录到了七次。

火山自5月20日起便躁动不安，到了8月26日至27日，活动达到灾难性的高潮。约三分之二的岛体塌入已被排空的岩浆房，没入海中。据报道，局部高逾30米的海啸淹没了爪哇和苏门答腊的沿海居民点。荷兰殖民当局统计死亡36417人，大多为溺亡，而这一数字还可能偏低。

从巴达维亚，也就是今天的雅加达发出的电报，经海底电缆转发，数小时内便抵达伦敦。西方报纸很快开始报道这起常被称为首个全球新闻事件的灾难。然而，早期电讯十分简短，灾情究竟有多严重，直到几天后才逐渐清楚。

火山灰和二氧化硫被抛向数十公里高空，形成的薄雾约用两周便绕赤道一圈。1883年11月，深红的晚霞照亮欧洲和北美；纽约州和康涅狄格州的消防员甚至被引去扑救并不存在的大火。后来的气候重建研究推测，次年全球气温下降了零点几度。

一些专家不接受火山解释，认为晚霞来自高空水汽或宇宙尘埃。1884年2月，英国皇家学会通过《泰晤士报》征集注明日期的观测记录，得到世界各地的回应；学会1888年的报告将红霞与喀拉喀托联系起来。借助气压计、电缆和绯红的天空，相隔遥远的观测者开始看见：地球各处原来早已相互关联。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

unleash v.
释放；迸发出
unleashed its most thunderous

thunderous adj.
雷鸣般响亮的
its most thunderous explosion.

barometer n.
气压计
Barometers worldwide recorded the

atmospheric adj.
大气的
the atmospheric pressure wave,

catastrophic adj.
灾难性的
a catastrophic climax on 26–27 August.

climax n.
高潮；顶点
a catastrophic climax on 26–27 August.

collapse into phr.v.
塌入
the island collapsed into its emptied

reportedly adv.
据报道
Tsunamis, reportedly over 30 metres

swamp v.
淹没
swamped coastal settlements on Java

underestimate v.
低估
perhaps underestimating the toll.

toll n.
死亡人数；伤亡总数
perhaps underestimating the toll.

relay v.
转发；传递
relayed by submarine cable,

terse adj.
简短的
Yet early dispatches were terse;

magnitude n.
规模；程度
the magnitude of the devastation

devastation n.
严重破坏；浩劫
the devastation emerged piecemeal over

piecemeal adv.
一点一点地
the devastation emerged piecemeal over

haze n.
薄雾；霾
haze that circled the equator in about

reconstruction n.
重建；历史状况复原
Later climate reconstructions suggest

discount v.
不予采信；低估
Some experts discounted the volcanic

elicit v.
引起；引出
eliciting worldwide replies;

far-flung adj.
相隔遥远的
far-flung observers began to glimpse

interconnected adj.
相互关联的
how interconnected the planet already

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

volcanic adj.
火山的

strait n.
海峡

islander n.
岛民

roar n.
轰鸣；咆哮声

distant adj.
远处的

gunfire n.
炮火声；枪炮射击

restless adj.
躁动不安的

emptied adj.
被排空的

magma n.
岩浆

vanish v.
消失

tsunami n.
海啸

coastal adj.
沿海的

settlement n.
居民点；聚居地

colonial adj.
殖民地的

administrator n.
行政官员

drown v.
溺亡

telegram n.
电报

submarine adj.
海底的

cable n.
电缆

chronicle v.
记述；报道

dispatch n.
电讯；发回的报道

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

ash n.
灰；此处指火山灰

sulphur n.
硫

hurl v.
猛抛；抛射

equator n.
赤道

crimson adj.
深红色的

glow v.
发光；泛出光彩

summon v.
召来

firefighter n.
消防员

phantom adj.
虚幻的；并不存在的

blaze n.
大火

dip v.
小幅下降

sunset n.
晚霞；日落

moisture n.
水汽；水分

at high altitude prep.phr.
在高空

cosmic adj.
宇宙的

Royal Society proper n.
英国皇家学会

appeal v.
呼吁

tie to phr.v.
与to连用：把……联系起来

to prep.
标示联系到的对象

observer n.
观察者；观测者

glimpse v.
初步认识到；窥见

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 _____ its most thunderous explosion.

02 Tsunamis, _____ over 30 metres high in places,

03 Yet early dispatches were _____;

04 how _____ the planet already was.

文章主线

- 巨响 1883年喀拉喀托火山喷发，声传近4800公里；全球气压计录到压力波，有些约5天录到7次。
- 灾难 约三分之二岛体塌入已排空的岩浆房并没入海中；海啸据报局部逾30米，官方记36417人死亡，多数溺亡，或仍低估。
- 快讯 海底电缆让电报数小时到伦敦，消息迅速全球传播；但早期报道简短，灾情规模数日后才逐渐清楚。
- 余波 火山灰和二氧化硫形成高空薄雾，远方出现红霞；后来的气候重建提示，1884年全球降温零点几度。
- 考证 有人把红霞归于高空水汽或宇宙尘埃；皇家学会汇集全球观测，1888年报告将红霞与喷发联系起来。

参考答案　1 unleashed 2 reportedly 3 terse 4 interconnected

光之殇

Lost in the Glare



昆虫绕着灯飞，真只是因为喜欢光吗？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

A moth skims over an ultraviolet lamp and flips upside down, belly to the sky. In Costa Rica's misty Monteverde cloud-forest, stereo cameras caught such acrobatics for a 2024 Imperial College study that unravelled an age-old puzzle, the helpless swirl of insects round porch lights.

Folk wisdom blames the circling on attraction. In fact, insects instinctively keep their backs to whatever shines brightest, normally the sky, to stay level. A lamp, a counterfeit sky, hijacks this built-in habit, leaving insects eddying in its halo or inverted above it. In 477 field clips, precious few darted straight at the light.

Many fireflies flirt with their lanterns. A male blinks an overture, a female winks back, and bright nights smother the banter. At Tufts University, suitors under artificial light mustered about five flash patterns a minute instead of ten. Females reciprocated about half as often under red or blue light, scarcely at all under white, and never under amber.

The harm spills into the ecosystem. Along 55 Thames Valley roadsides, lamp-lit hedges held 47% fewer moth caterpillars than dark ones, with harsh white LEDs worse than mellower sodium lamps. Street lamps rigged up in seven of 14 Swiss meadows cut nocturnal pollinator visits by 62%. The plants set fewer fruit, and daytime pollinators proved poor understudies.

Over 80% of humanity lives beneath a luminous veil, which hides the pale ribbon of the Milky Way from more than a third. Citizen scientists' star counts from 2011 to 2022 show the sky brightening about 9.6% a year. At that pace, a child born where 250 stars twinkle would see about 100 by their eighteenth birthday.

中文译文

一只飞蛾掠过紫外灯，突然翻转，肚皮朝向天空。2024年伦敦帝国理工学院的一项研究，在哥斯达黎加蒙特韦尔德雾气弥漫的云雾林中，用立体摄像机捕捉到这样的飞行动作，解开了一个古老谜团：昆虫为什么会身不由己地绕着门廊灯盘旋。

人们通常认为，昆虫绕灯飞是受到灯光吸引。实际上，为保持身体平稳，昆虫会本能地让背部朝向最亮的方向，通常就是天空。人造灯冒充了天空，扰乱这种天生习性，使昆虫在光晕中打转，或在灯上方翻倒。477段野外录像中，真正径直冲向光源的昆虫寥寥无几。

许多萤火虫用发光来求偶：雄虫先闪光，雌虫再回应，太亮的夜晚却会淹没这番交流。在塔夫茨大学的实验中，人造光下的雄虫每分钟只能发出约五组闪光，而原本约有十组。实验中的雌虫在红光或蓝光下回应的次数约减半，在白光下几乎没有回应，在琥珀色光下则完全没有回应。

影响还延伸到生态系统。对泰晤士河谷55处路边的调查发现，有灯照明的树篱里，蛾类毛虫比无灯处少47%；刺眼的白色LED处，情况比柔和的钠灯处更严重。在瑞士14片草甸中的7片临时架起路灯后，夜间传粉者的造访减少62%。植物结的果实也更少，白天的传粉者未能补足夜间的损失。

全球超过80%的人口生活在发光的夜空帷幕下，超过三分之一的人看不到银河那条淡淡的光带。参与观星的公众在2011年至2022年间记录的星数表明，夜空每年约变亮9.6%。按这一速度，一个孩子出生时若能在当地看到250颗星，到18岁时便大约只能看到100颗。

树篱毛虫少47%来自路边调查；草甸的62%来自架灯实验，不应把两种证据都写成同一种因果证明。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

skim over 动词短语
掠过
A moth skims over an ultraviolet lamp

unravel v.
解开（谜团）
unravelled an age-old puzzle

age-old adj.
由来已久的
an age-old puzzle

folk wisdom n.
民间流传的观念
Folk wisdom blames the circling

attraction n.
吸引
blames the circling on attraction

instinctively adv.
本能地
insects instinctively keep their backs

counterfeit adj.
假冒的
a counterfeit sky

hijack v.
劫持；此处指扰乱
hijacks this built-in habit

built-in adj.
与生俱来的
this built-in habit

inverted adj.
翻转倒置的
inverted above it

precious few 数量短语
少之又少
precious few darted straight

reciprocate v.
回应
Females reciprocated

ecosystem n.
生态系统
The harm spills into the ecosystem

caterpillar n.
毛虫；蛾蝶幼虫
47% fewer moth caterpillars

harsh adj.
刺眼的；强烈的
harsh white LEDs

sodium lamp n.
钠灯
mellower sodium lamps

rig up 动词短语
临时架设
Street lamps rigged up

nocturnal adj.
夜间的
nocturnal pollinator visits

understudy n.
替补
proved poor understudies

luminous adj.
发光的
a luminous veil

citizen n.
公民；此处指公众参与者
Citizen scientists' star counts

pace n.
速度
At that pace

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共32项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

belly n.
腹部

misty adj.
雾气弥漫的

cloud forest n.
云雾林

stereo adj.
立体成像的

acrobatics n.
杂技般的动作

helpless adj.
身不由己的

swirl n.
盘旋；打转

porch n.
门廊

eddy v.
打旋

halo n.
光晕

clip n.
视频片段

dart v.
猛冲；疾驰

flirt v.
求偶；调情

lantern n.
灯笼；此处喻发光器官

blink v.
闪烁

overture n.
序曲；此处喻求偶信号

wink v.
眨眼；此处喻闪光回应

smother v.
压制；淹没

banter n.
打趣；此处喻求偶交流

suitor n.
求偶者

muster v.
勉强发出（闪光）

amber n.
琥珀色

spill into 动词短语
蔓延到

roadside n.
路边

lamp-lit adj.
有灯照明的

hedge n.
树篱

mellow adj.
较柔和的

meadow n.
草甸

humanity n.
全人类

veil n.
帷幕

ribbon n.
带状物；光带

twinkle v.
闪烁

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 In fact, insects _____ keep their backs to whatever shines brightest, normally the sky, to stay level.

02 A lamp, a _____ sky, hijacks this built-in habit, leaving insects eddying in its halo or inverted above it.

03 Females _____ about half as often under red or blue light, scarcely at all under white, and never under amber.

04 Street lamps rigged up in seven of 14 Swiss meadows cut _____ pollinator visits by 62%.

文章主线

- 迷向 昆虫本能地背朝最亮处以保持平稳；2024年研究发现，灯冒充天空，扰乱这种习性，使昆虫绕灯打转或翻身。
- 求偶 萤火虫靠闪光求偶；实验中人造光使雄虫闪光约减半，雌虫在红蓝光下回应减半，白光下极少、琥珀光下全无。
- 幼虫 英国55处路边调查中，有灯树篱的蛾类毛虫比暗处少47%；白色LED的影响重于钠灯。
- 传粉 瑞士草甸架灯实验使夜间传粉访问减少62%、植物结实减少；白天传粉未能补足夜间损失。
- 夜空 全球逾八成人口受光污染影响，逾三分之一看不见银河；2011—2022年公众观星记录显示，夜空年均增亮约9.6%。

参考答案　1 instinctively 2 counterfeit 3 reciprocated 4 nocturnal

冰海求生：坚忍号传奇

Survival in the Ice: The Legend of Endurance



冰海中的精确计算，怎样换来生路？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

On 5 December 1914 Endurance departed South Georgia, a remote whaling outpost, for Antarctica's Weddell Sea. In January 1915 ice trapped the vessel. On 27 October, her hull buckling, the men abandoned ship. She foundered on 21 November; her captain, Frank Worsley, logged the spot.

The stranded men endured over five gruelling months on the ice. Their floe split on 9 April 1916; on 15 April their lifeboats reached Elephant Island, a bleak, uninhabited rock far from shipping lanes.

On 24 April Shackleton and five others embarked in the James Caird, a fragile lifeboat, on a perilous voyage of some 1,300 kilometres. As ferocious gales battered the boat, Worsley snatched only four sights of the sun, deducing the rest by dead reckoning from course, speed, and time elapsed. On 10 May they landed on South Georgia's deserted south coast.

Shackleton, Worsley, and Tom Crean traversed its mountainous interior in about 36 exhausting hours, reaching the Stromness whaling station on 20 May. Ice repelled three rescue attempts before the Yelcho, a Chilean tug, evacuated the 22 marooned men on 30 August. All 28 of Endurance's party survived their ordeal.

On 5 March 2022 searchers located the wreck 3,008 metres down, upright and intact. She lay about four miles south of the spot Worsley recorded in November 1915, months before the voyage: a slight discrepancy for a calculation on shifting ice.

Legend rightly salutes Shackleton for his charisma. Yet both ends of the story hinge on Worsley's meticulous arithmetic. Leadership held 28 men together. Precision put six ashore within reach of help and, a century on, brought their ship back into view.

中文译文

1914年12月5日，坚忍号驶离偏远的捕鲸据点南乔治亚岛，前往南极威德尔海。1915年1月，海冰困住了船。10月27日，船体受压变形，众人弃船；11月21日，坚忍号沉没，船长弗兰克·沃斯利记下了沉没地点。

自弃船起，被困的人们在冰上熬过五个多月的艰苦日子。1916年4月9日，他们脚下的浮冰裂开。4月15日，救生艇抵达象岛，那是一座荒凉、无人居住、远离航线的岩岛。

4月24日，沙克尔顿和另外五人登上单薄的救生艇詹姆斯·凯尔德号，开始约1300公里的危险航程。猛烈大风不断冲击小艇，沃斯利只抓住四次机会观测太阳定位，其余时间靠航向、航速和经过的时间作航位推算。5月10日，他们登上南乔治亚岛空无一人的南岸。

沙克尔顿、沃斯利和汤姆·克林用了约36小时，艰苦横越岛上多山的腹地，于5月20日抵达斯特罗姆内斯捕鲸站。浮冰逼退了三次救援尝试，直到8月30日，智利拖船耶乔号才将象岛上受困的22人接走。坚忍号这一队的28人全都挺过磨难、生还归来。

2022年3月5日，搜寻者在3008米深的海底发现沉船，它保持正立，完好无损。沉船位于沃斯利在1915年11月记录的位置以南约四英里；那是小艇求援航程开始前几个月记下的位置。在漂移冰面上完成的计算只有这点偏差，已属难得。

后世因沙克尔顿的个人感召力称颂他，确有道理。但故事的前后两端，都取决于沃斯利一丝不苟的计算。领导力让28人团结在一起，精确计算则让六人登岸，进入可以求援的范围；一个世纪后，又让他们的船重新进入世人的视野。

28人指坚忍号这一队；1915年记录的沉船位置早于1916年的求援航程。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

hull n.
船体
her hull buckling

buckle v.
受压弯曲；变形
her hull buckling

founder v.
沉没
foundered on 21 November

stranded adj.
受困的；滞留的
The stranded men

gruelling adj.
艰苦难熬的
over five gruelling months

floe n.
浮冰块
Their floe split

bleak adj.
荒凉的；凄冷的
a bleak, uninhabited rock

embark v.
登船；启程
embarked in the James Caird

perilous adj.
危险重重的
a perilous voyage

ferocious adj.
猛烈的；凶猛的
As ferocious gales

deduce v.
推算；推断
deducing the rest

dead reckoning 名词短语
航位推算，按航向等估计位置
by dead reckoning

traverse v.
横越；穿过
traversed its mountainous interior

repel v.
逼退；阻退
Ice repelled three rescue attempts

evacuate v.
撤出；疏散
evacuated the 22 marooned men

marooned adj.
困在荒岛上的
evacuated the 22 marooned men

ordeal n.
磨难；严酷考验
survived their ordeal

intact adj.
完好无损的
upright and intact

discrepancy n.
偏差；差异
a slight discrepancy

charisma n.
个人魅力；感召力
for his charisma

hinge on 动词短语
取决于
hinge on Worsley's

meticulous adj.
一丝不苟的；细致的
Worsley's meticulous arithmetic

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共45项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

depart v.
驶离；离开

remote adj.
偏远的

whaling n.
捕鲸

outpost n.
偏远据点；前哨站

for prep.
前往；开往

trap v.
困住

vessel n.
船舶

abandon v.
弃船；放弃

log v.
记入航海日志

endure v.
忍受；熬过

lifeboat n.
救生艇

uninhabited adj.
无人居住的

shipping lane 名词短语
航线

in prep.
表示所乘的船

fragile adj.
单薄易损的；脆弱的

on prep.
表示所踏上的航程

voyage n.
航程；航海

gale n.
大风；强风

batter v.
反复猛击

snatch v.
抓住机会；匆忙取得

sight of the sun 名词短语
观测太阳以确定位置

course n.
航向

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共45项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

time elapsed 名词短语
经过的时间

land on 动词短语
在……登陆；登上

deserted adj.
空无一人的

mountainous adj.
多山的

interior n.
腹地；内部

exhausting adj.
令人筋疲力尽的

rescue attempt 名词短语
救援尝试

tug n.
拖船

locate v.
找到；确定位置

wreck n.
沉船残骸

upright adj.
正立的；直立的

calculation n.
计算

shifting adj.
漂移的；不断移动的

rightly adv.
理所应当地；有道理地

salute v.
称颂；致敬

arithmetic n.
算术；计算

leadership n.
领导力

hold v.
使保持；使团结

together adv.
在一起；团结一致

precision n.
精准；精确性

ashore adv.
上岸；在岸上

bring v.
使进入视野；带来

back adv.
重新；返回

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 On 27 October, her hull _____, the men abandoned ship.

02 deducing the rest by _____ from course, speed, and time elapsed.

03 She lay about four miles south of the spot Worsley recorded in November 1915, months before the voyage: a slight _____ for a calculation on shifting ice.

04 Yet both ends of the story hinge on Worsley's _____ arithmetic.

文章主线

- 受困 1915年，坚忍号被南极海冰困住，10月弃船、11月沉没；船长沃斯利记下位置，众人自弃船起在浮冰上熬过五个多月。
- 求援 浮冰破裂后，众人乘救生艇抵象岛；岛远离航线，沙克尔顿等六人再乘小艇航行约1300公里，到南乔治亚岛求援。
- 导航 沃斯利仅四次观测太阳定位，其余靠航向、速度和时间推算；登岸后，三人再翻山约36小时找到捕鲸站。
- 获救 三次救援被冰逼退，智利拖船于1916年8月接回象岛22人，坚忍号28人全部生还。
- 寻回 2022年沉船在旧记录点以南约四英里处找到；沙克尔顿凝聚众人，沃斯利的计算则既助求援，也助寻船。

参考答案　1 buckling 2 dead reckoning 3 discrepancy 4 meticulous

一枚邮票改变通信

The Stamp That Changed the Post



一枚邮票怎样简化寄信，又怎样防止重复使用？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

Before 1840, British postage was levied according to the number of sheets in a letter and the mileage of its carriage. The sum was usually payable on delivery, so the person receiving the correspondence, not the sender, settled it. Prices thus fluctuated from one postal item to the next.

In 1837 Rowland Hill published a booklet urging reform. Parliament enacted the campaigner's proposal in 1839, and on 10 January 1840 the Uniform Penny Post began. A letter of up to half an ounce now cost one penny to any destination in Britain, and the fee was prepaid by whoever sent it. One flat-rate charge replaced variation with simplicity.

The Penny Black, a one-penny denomination, was released on 1 May 1840, its validity starting on 6 May. Engraved on it was a youthful likeness of Queen Victoria, the reigning monarch. An aggregate of 68,808,000 were printed. The sheets had no holes for separation, so each stamp was cut out individually with scissors.

Mailings doubled, from about 80 million items in 1839 to over 169 million in 1840. The design had a drawback. Against black, the red cancelling mark was barely noticeable, lacking contrast, and the ink could be erased, leaving stamps vulnerable to reuse. In February 1841 the Penny Red, cancelled in black ink, arrived to deter tampering and fraud.

As the initiator of postage stamps, Britain set a precedent and earned an exemption. Its stamps are nameless, with no country inscribed on them. By international agreement, the sovereign's head suffices for identification, an implicit designation that other countries spell out in print.

中文译文

1840年以前，英国邮费按信内纸张数量与运输里程收取，通常在投递时付款。因此，结清邮费的往往是收信人，而非寄信人，每件邮件的价格也不相同。

1837年，罗兰·希尔出版小册子，呼吁改革。议会于1839年通过了他的提议，统一便士邮资在1840年1月10日开始实行：半盎司（约14克）以内的信，寄往英国境内任何地方都只收一便士，由寄信人预付。一项统一费率让原来各不相同的收费变得简单。

面值一便士的黑便士邮票于1840年5月1日发行，5月6日起可用于邮寄。邮票上刻有当时在位君主维多利亚女王的年轻肖像，共印制68,808,000枚。整版邮票没有用来分开的齿孔，每一枚都要用剪刀单独剪下。

邮寄量翻了一番，从1839年的约8000万件增加至1840年的1.69亿多件。但设计也有缺点：红色盖销印在黑底上缺少反差，很不显眼，而且红色墨迹能被擦掉，邮票因此容易被重复使用。1841年2月，改用黑色墨水盖销的红便士邮票问世，以阻止篡改和欺诈。

英国作为邮票首创国，开创先例，也获得一项特例：邮票上可以不印国名。按照国际协议，只凭君主头像就足以识别国家；这是一种隐含的国家标识，其他国家则需要把国名直接印出来。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

postage n.
邮费
British postage was levied

levy v.
征收
levied according to the number

mileage n.
里程
the mileage of its carriage

payable adj.
应支付的
usually payable on delivery

correspondence n.
信件
receiving the correspondence

fluctuate v.
波动；各不相同
Prices thus fluctuated

enact v.
立法通过
Parliament enacted

proposal n.
提议；方案
the campaigner's proposal

prepay v.
预付
the fee was prepaid

flat-rate charge 名词短语
统一费率收费
One flat-rate charge

denomination n.
面值
a one-penny denomination

validity n.
效力；有效期
its validity starting on 6 May

aggregate n.
总计；总数
aggregate of 68,808,000

mailing n.
邮寄件数；邮件
Mailings doubled

drawback n.
缺点
The design had a drawback

cancelling mark 名词短语
邮票盖销印记
the red cancelling mark

contrast n.
反差
lacking contrast

vulnerable to 形容词短语
容易遭到；易受……影响
vulnerable to reuse

deter v.
阻止；遏制
to deter tampering and fraud

fraud n.
欺诈
to deter tampering and fraud

precedent n.
先例
Britain set a precedent

exemption n.
豁免；特例
earned an exemption

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共34项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

sheet n.
纸张

carriage n.
运输

delivery n.
投递

sender n.
寄信人

postal adj.
邮政的

item n.
一件邮件；物品

booklet n.
小册子

campaigner n.
改革倡导者

ounce n.
盎司

penny n.
便士

destination n.
目的地

variation n.
差异；变化

simplicity n.
简便

engrave v.
雕刻；刻印

youthful adj.
年轻的

likeness n.
肖像

reigning adj.
在位的

monarch n.
君主

separation n.
分离

individually adv.
单独地

scissors n.
剪刀

item n.
一件件邮件；物品

noticeable adj.
显眼的

erase v.
擦除

reuse n.
重复使用

tampering n.
篡改；擅自改动

initiator n.
首创者；发起者

nameless adj.
此处指未印国名的

inscribe v.
刻印

sovereign n.
君主

suffice for 动词短语
足以用于

identification n.
识别

implicit adj.
隐含的

designation n.
标识；名称

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 and the fee was _____ by whoever sent it.

02 An _____ of 68,808,000 were printed.

03 The design had a _____.

04 Britain set a precedent and earned an _____.

文章主线

- 旧制 英国邮费原按信纸数量和运输距离计算，通常由收信人付款，每封信的价格不一。
- 改革 1840年1月起，希尔推动的改革让半盎司（约14克）以内的信在英国境内统一收一便士，由寄件人预付。
- 邮票 同年5月发行印有维多利亚女王头像的黑便士；当年邮寄量由上年约8000万件增至1.69亿多件。
- 改进 黑便士上的红色邮戳不显眼，红戳又可擦掉，使邮票容易被重用；1841年改发红便士并盖黑戳防重用。
- 特例 英国因首创邮票获国际特例，可不印国名，以君主头像标明国家；其他国家则要把国名印出。

参考答案　1 prepaid 2 aggregate 3 drawback 4 exemption